

Complex Instruction Following

A multi-sheet HR workflow is largely constructed, but key computed results remain unreadable in the final file.

1 Task description

2024 HR payroll and talent-review workbook

Convert seven source sheets into one auditable workbook covering payroll, performance, talent, labor cost, and management reporting.

7

source sheets

696

populated rows

6,189

source cells

INPUT HETEROGENEITY

Roster (41 rows), attendance (466), performance (158), plus salary adjustments, contribution rates, tax brackets, and department budgets.

OUTPUT EXPANSION

Preserve 7 raw sheets and build 6 analysis sheets: 1,747 populated rows and 26,425 populated cells in the submitted XLSX.

CALCULATION DEPENDENCIES

Handle five month formats, salary changes, leavers, department transfers, benefit caps/floors, cumulative tax, forced ranking, and nine-box logic.

VISUAL AND FILE CONSTRAINTS

Produce 4 KPI cards, 4 native Excel charts, filters, frozen headers, conditional formats, number formats, and 3 named ranges.

Cleaning + business rules + formulas + charts + file validation

2 Required execution path

1

Inspect seven source sheets

Connect roster, attendance, performance, adjustments, rates, tax brackets, and budgets.

2

Clean attendance

Normalize employee IDs and five month formats; compute deductions, overtime, and net adjustment.

3

Calculate monthly payroll

Build 465 employee-month rows; apply raises, exits, transfers, benefit caps/floors, and cumulative tax.

4

Calibrate annual performance

Combine quarterly weights, rank within departments, and apply ROUNDUP-based forced distribution.

5

Build the talent nine-box

Join annual performance with potential scores; assign nine categories and development actions.

6

Reconcile department cost

Aggregate six departments; compare wages and employer contributions with annual budgets.

7

Build dashboard and verify

Create 4 KPIs and 4 native charts; reopen the final XLSX and inspect computed result cells.

OBSERVED FAILURE POINTS

Monthly payroll: I2 and S13 | Management dashboard: B3

Formula text exists, but reopening the workbook returns no readable cached result.

3 Artifact outcome and judge evidence

What looked complete

13 sheets; 465 payroll rows; 4 native charts.

What failed

Three computed results are unreadable after reopening.

Submitted workbook excerpt (translated)

formula view + cached state

Monthly Payroll

Dashboard

Performance

Attendance Cleaning

Employee ID	Month	Attendance deduction	Overtime subsidy	Gross pay	Monthly tax
EMP001	2024-01	=IFERROR(SUMIFS(...),0)	=IFERROR(SUMIFS(...),0)	=E2+F2-G2+H2 Cached: None	=MAX(I0,T2) Cached: None
EMP001	2024-02	=IFERROR(SUMIFS(...),0)	=IFERROR(SUMIFS(...),0)	=E3+F3-G3+H3 Cached: None	=MAX(I0,T3-T2) Cached: None
EMP001	2024-12	=IFERROR(SUMIFS(...),0)	=IFERROR(SUMIFS(...),0)	=E13+F13-G13+H13 Cached: None	=MAX(I0,T13-T12) Cached: None

English rendering; formulas are shortened for legibility...

Artifact-level judge evidence

I2

Expected: gross pay 26000-27500

Judge: formula exists; data_only None

S13

Expected: taxable income 170k-182k

Judge: formula exists; cached None

B3

Expected: total payroll 8.4M-8.6M

Judge: dashboard KPI cached None

Formula presence does not confirm readable computed outputs.

Pattern: partial compliance

The agent completes the visible construction steps, but its final validation checks formula text rather than the computed-result state needed for a usable workbook.